

purchases to take advantage of specials, limiting take-away coffees to no more than, say, five per week and drinking plunger coffee at home at other times, and mending my shoes and clothes rather than disposing of them. Recently, it's even involved changing my hair colour, because the time and cost of being blonde were becoming ridiculous.

If you remember, I'm also from a working-class part of Sydney. We have a phenomenon in Australia called the 'tall poppy syndrome', a negative aspect of our culture where people are resented, attacked or criticised if they're seen to be superior to their peers. This tall poppy syndrome is exacerbated or magnified somewhat in the working-class area where I grew up, where you don't want to be seen to be a 'wanker', like someone from a more affluent suburb. It's an attitude that means you're not necessarily encouraged to seek too much financial success. A little bit is okay; just don't go too far—you don't want to eclipse your peers or make them feel less than.

Certainly, this is something I've experienced where I live—in my environment. This has included having it written and said that I thought I was getting too big for myself, a colloquialism that means, essentially, that I should know my place. This attitude resulted in me consciously changing my Money Environment. I found bigger ponds and different financial environments to play in, where people weren't necessarily threatened by my ambition and success. What that looked like in my day-to-day life was living for part of the week in a different area of Sydney and joining different networking groups, including one where the business size and the social makeup of the people intimidated me and challenged my thinking around what was possible for myself. I also chose to surround myself with people within my existing neighbourhood who were only interested in supporting one another (not kicking the ladder out from one another) and removed myself from regular contact with those who weren't supportive. It's how I combatted the messages I was receiving and reacting negatively to—by changing my Money Environment.

What about you? Later on in this chapter I'm going to pose questions to help you determine whether your Money Environment is serving you or sabotaging you, but I want you to start thinking about it now.

It's not just our physical environment that I'm referring to when I talk about our Money Environment. Our social circle, our business circle, our